

Compensation Intelligence Report

Tool

Date

May 12, 2026, 4:34 PM

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Executive Summary with Search Parameters

Project

Hiring Test Engineer - 2026-05-12

Date

May 12, 2026, 4:34 PM

Role

Testing Engineer

Experience

2-4

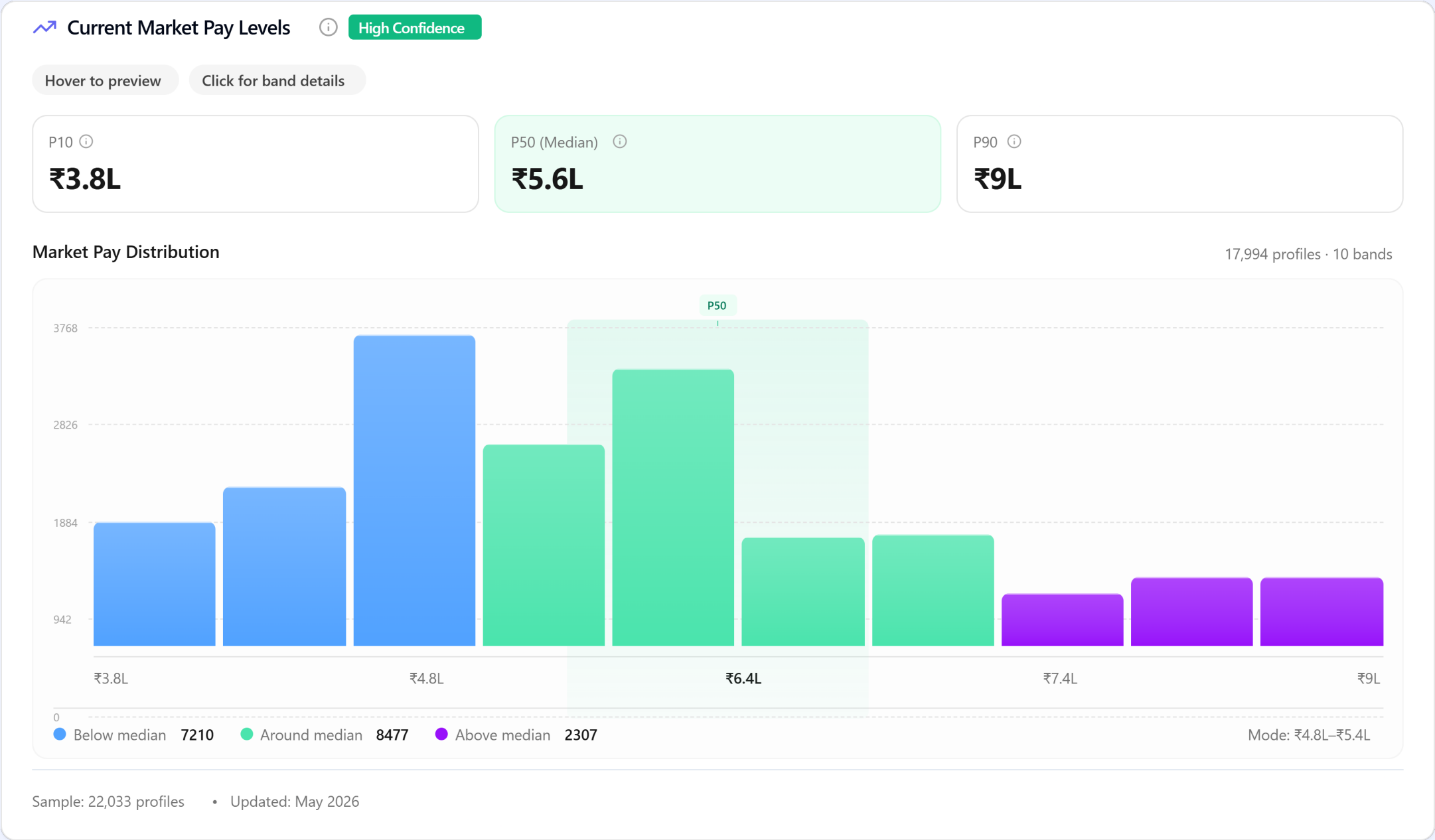
Locations

Bengaluru, Chennai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Mumbai, Pune

Archetype

IT Services & Consulting

Benchmark Overview - Pay and Skill Levels



Skill Value Drivers ⓘ

Top categories by P50 uplift

Building scalable automation frameworks from scratch.

Integrating automated tests into CI/CD pipelines.

Optimizing parallel test execution for speed.

17%-22%

12%-16%

7%-11%

Pro Tip: ⓘ

Percentages show uplift versus overall cohort median (P50).

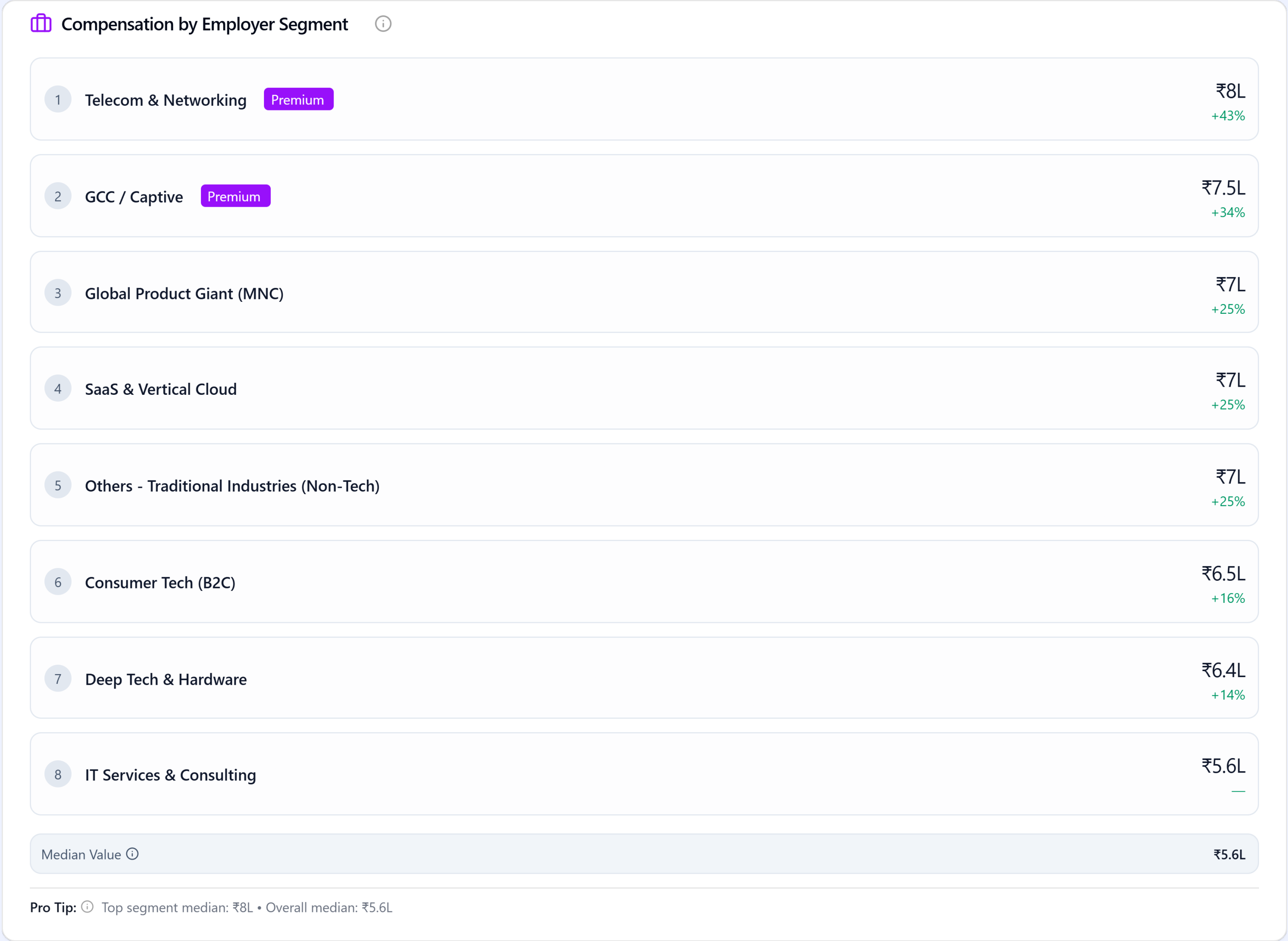
Benchmark Overview - Median



Benchmark Overview - Pay Progression



Benchmark Overview - By Employer Segment



Benchmark Overview - Pay Positioning

 Recommended Pay Positioning 

Talent-optimized for competitive positioning

 Minimum Competitive Level 

₹5.5L-₹5.6L

Minimum competitive offering

 Market-Aligned Positioning 

₹6L

Competitive market positioning

 Premium Positioning (Top Talent) 

₹7L-₹7.2L

Top 10% + critical skills premium

Benchmark Overview - Data & Benchmark Coverage

Data Quality & Benchmark Coverage

Dataset characteristics and methodology

B Benchmark Sample Size ⓘ
22,033

Geographic Scope 6

 Geographic Scope

Bengaluru

Chennai

Pune

Delhi

Hyderabad

Mumbai

✓ Employer Segment Coverage ⓘ

IT Services & Consulting

SaaS & Vertical Cloud

Telecom & Networking

Global Product Giant (M...

Consumer Tech (B2C)

Others - Traditional Indu...

GCC / Captive

Deep Tech & Hardware

Benchmarking Methodology

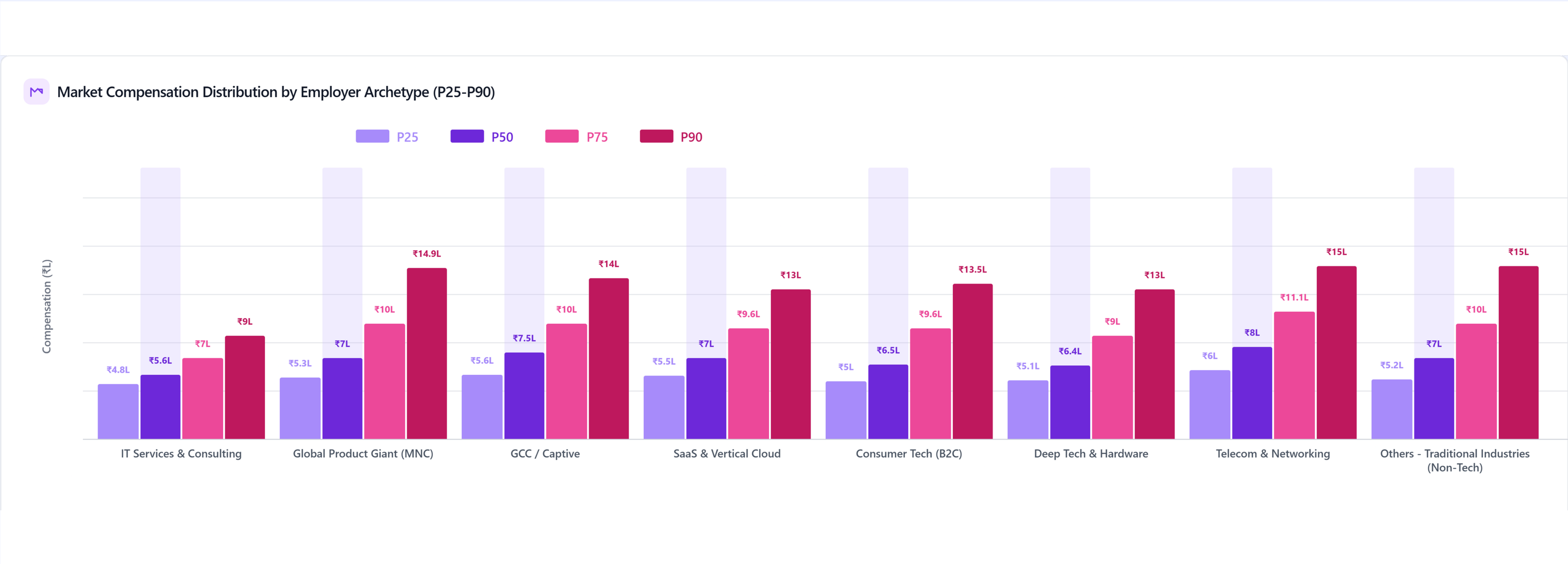
Rolling 6-month delayed validation with cross-referencing

 Confidence Level

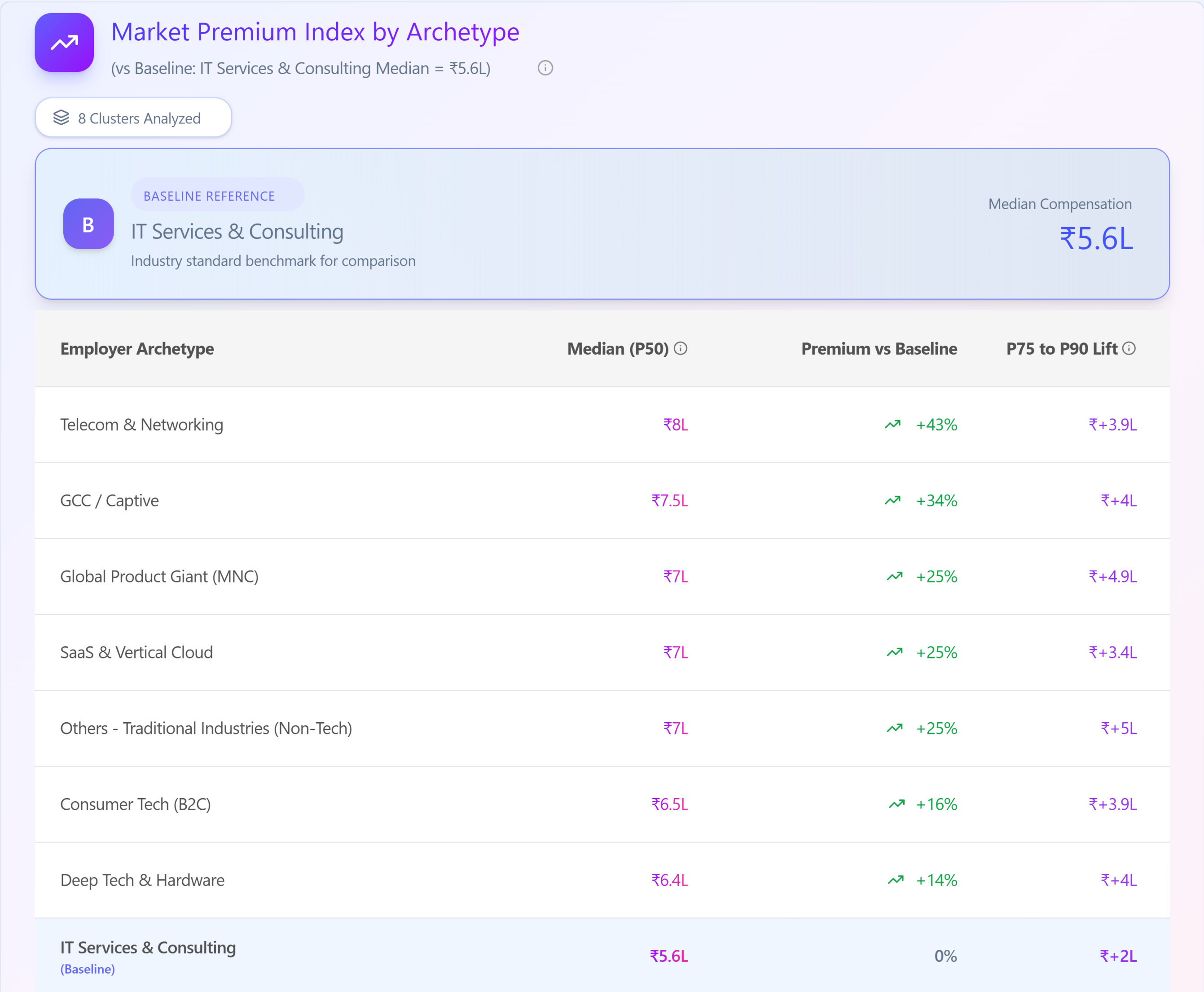
High Confidence

- Last updated: May 2026 ⓘ

Benchmark Employer - By Employer Archetype



Benchmark Employer - Premium Index

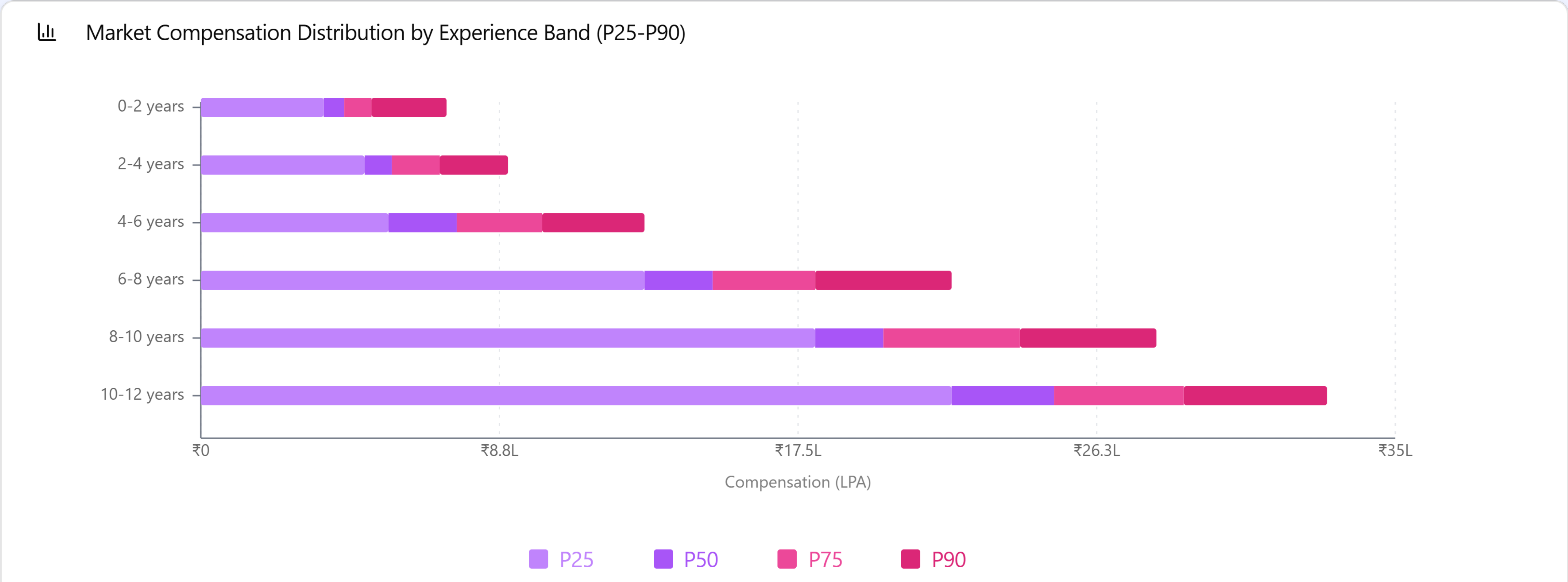


Benchmark Employer - Compensation Strategy

 Advisory Insights for Compensation Strategy

#	 INFERENCE
1	Telecom & Networking shows the highest median premium at +42.86% versus IT Services & Consulting, making it the highest median-paying archetype in the dataset and the clearest structural pay leader relative to the base archetype.
2	0 has the highest dispersion index at 0.7682, placing it in the moderately differentiated range and indicating the greatest compensation differentiation in the dataset.
3	Others - Traditional Industries (Non-Tech) has the highest top-end ratio at 2.1429x, which is 114.29% above median, representing the highest upper-tail leverage in the dataset and signaling a top-heavy pay structure.

Benchmark Experience - Compensation by Experience



Benchmark Experience - Premium Index



Experience Premium Index

(vs Baseline: 2-4 years Median = ₹5.6L) ⓘ



6 Clusters Analyzed

B

BASELINE REFERENCE

2-4

Industry standard benchmark for comparison

Median Compensation

₹5.6L

Experience Band	Median (P50) ⓘ	Premium vs Baseline	P75 to P90 Lift ⓘ
10-12 Years	₹25L	↗ +346%	₹+4.2L
8-10 Years	₹20L	↗ +257%	₹+4L
6-8 Years	₹15L	↗ +168%	₹+4L
4-6 Years	₹7.5L	↗ +34%	₹+3L
2-4 Years (Baseline)	₹5.6L	0%	₹+2L
0-2 Years	₹4.2L	↗ -25%	₹2.2L

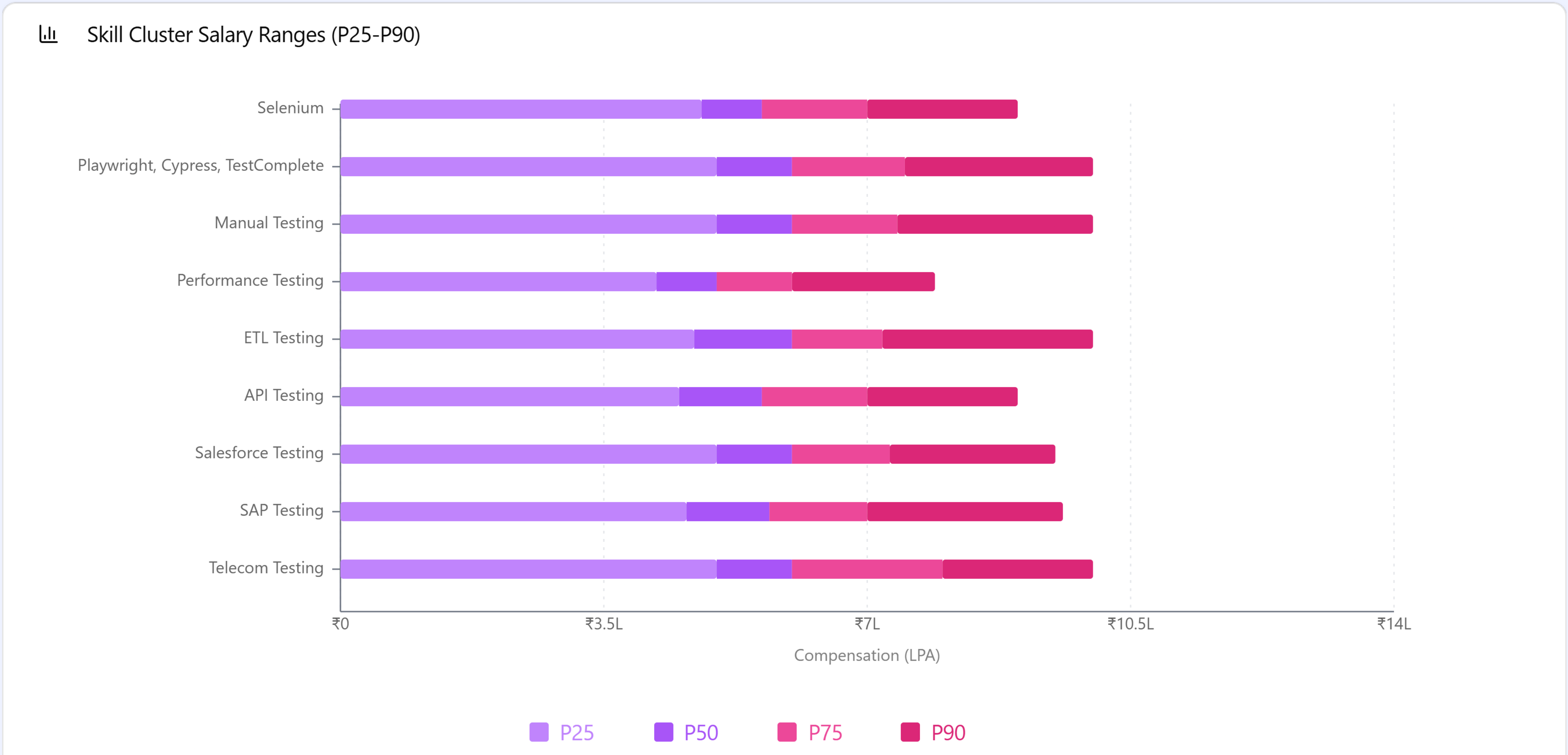
Benchmark Experience - Compensation Strategy

💡 Advisory Insights for Compensation Strategy

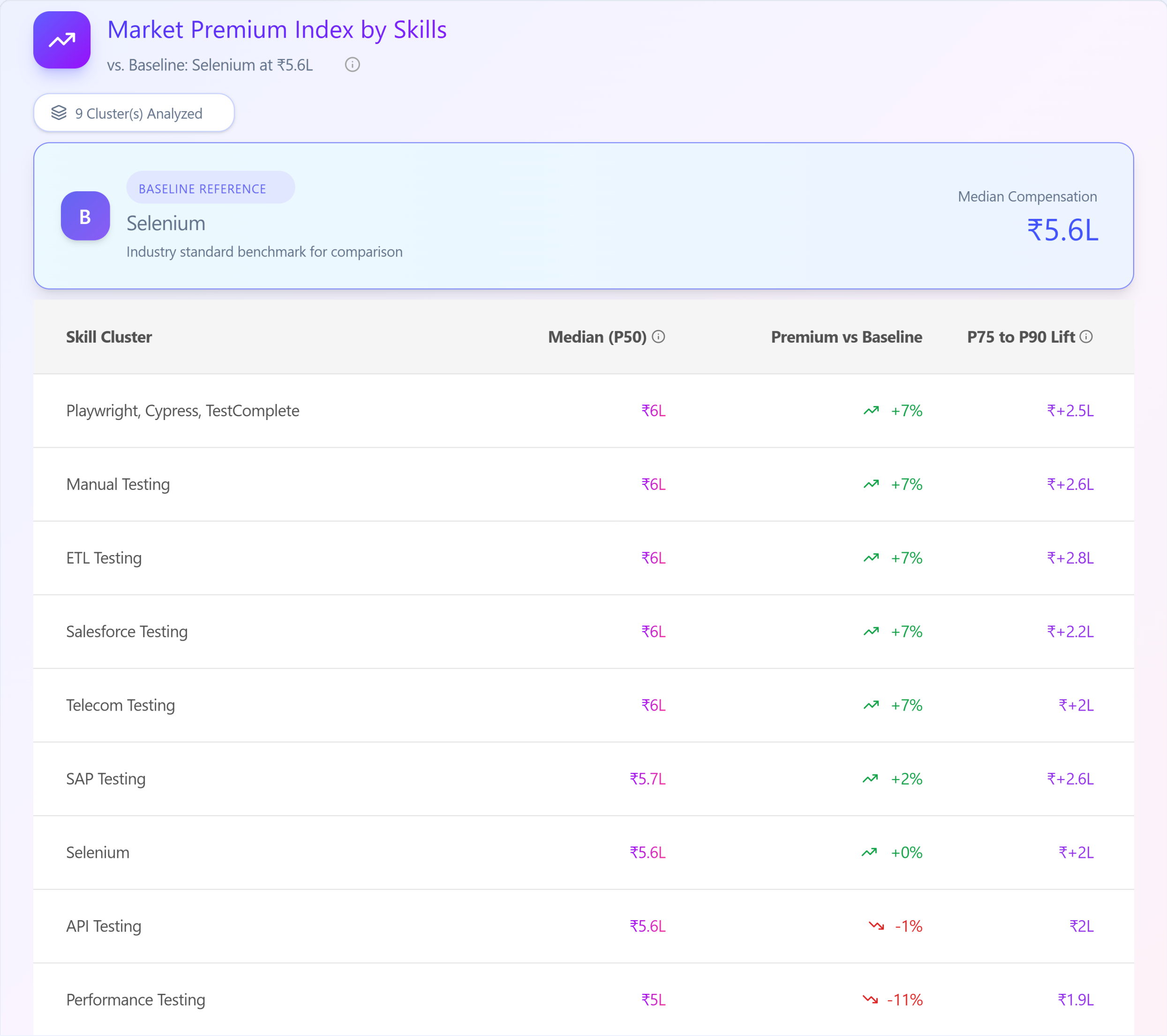
INFERENCE

- 1 Compensation progression is highly uneven and effectively front- and mid-career weighted, with the sharpest step-up occurring between 4-6 and 6-8 years at 100%. By contrast, progression falls to 25% in the 8-10 to 10-12 transition, the lowest point in the sequence, indicating that pay velocity slows materially at later stages. This is not a linear pricing curve; it reflects a plateauing pattern after a pronounced mid-career inflection, suggesting the market rewards incremental experience most strongly as employees move into the first senior band, then becomes more conservative thereafter.
- 2 Pay compression is material and widespread, with overlap identified across four adjacent band transitions, including the early-career and senior-career steps. This pattern indicates that internal pay differentiation is not consistently preserved as employees progress, creating a meaningful risk that promotion moves may not deliver a clear compensation premium. From a talent management perspective, this can weaken the perceived value of advancement, complicate offer setting for experienced hires, and increase internal equity pressure where adjacent bands are priced too closely together.
- 3 The upper tail shows senior compression rather than top-end acceleration, as p90 growth at 361.54% trails p50 growth at 491.72%. This indicates that pay is expanding more strongly at the median than at the top of the distribution, which is consistent with a narrowing reward premium for the most senior experience levels. In practical terms, the market appears to be limiting escalation for scarce senior talent relative to the broader population, signaling constrained differentiation at the upper end rather than a deliberate premium for elite expertise.

Benchmark Skills - Salary Ranges



Benchmark Skills - Premium Index



Benchmark Skills - Compensation Strategy

 Advisory Insights for Compensation Strategy

INFERENCE

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | Selenium is the baseline cluster, so it does not command a premium over itself. On the available evidence, this points to a market anchor skill rather than a differentiated capability tier, suggesting compensation is being priced as a core testing competency with limited incremental uplift attached to the skill alone. |
| 2 | The Selenium pay distribution is tightly governed, with a dispersion index of 0.3929 and a top-end ratio of 1.6071. This indicates relatively compressed pay outcomes and only moderate upper-tail stretch, consistent with a mature, standardised skill where market pricing is broadly consistent across practitioners rather than concentrated among a small elite. |
| 3 | The pattern most consistent with these signals is Mature & Standardised Skill. The very large sample size, near-baseline positioning, low dispersion, and limited top-end stretch indicate a well-established market with low concentration risk and limited scope for scarcity-driven pay inflation. Compensation appears to be driven more by role context and individual performance than by Selenium skill scarcity. |

Benchmark Compare - Search Scenario

Scenario A

Skills

Selenium

Experience

0-2 years

Location

Ahmedabad

Employer Archetype

IT Services & Consulting

Scenario B

Skills

Selenium

Experience

0-2 years

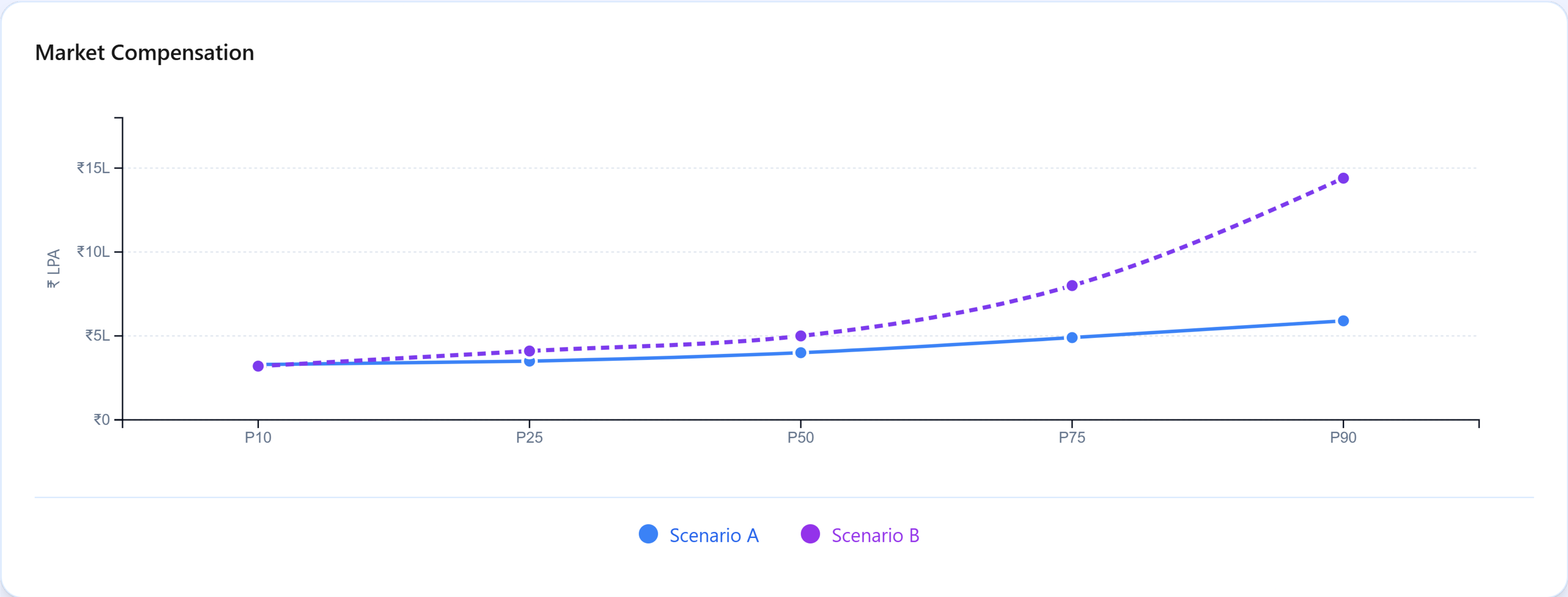
Location

Bengaluru

Employer Archetype

Global Product Giant (MNC)

Benchmark Compare - Market Compensation



Median (p50)	₹4L vs ₹5L
Upper Range (p65)	₹4.9L vs ₹8L

Benchmark Compare - Decision Summary

Cost Impact

Planned Headcount: 50

Total Annual Cost

Each scenario: median (p50) × planned headcount → total annual compensation.

Scenario A	₹2 Cr
	₹4L × 50

Scenario B	₹2.5 Cr
	₹5L × 50

₹50L

₹50L more with Scenario B

Choosing Scenario B will result in higher overall compensation costs due to a ₹1L higher median salary per employee. For 50 planned hires, this translates to an additional ₹50L in total compensation expense compared to Scenario A.

Thank You!

Contact Us

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